

ICE Tea Tools – Pod Organizer Handbook

Version 1.0

Introduction: What Is a Pod?

A **pod** is a **small, trusted, community-based unit** designed to protect and empower people during times of state harassment, immigration raids, or community crises.

Pods usually consist of **2–10 members** who are committed to each other's safety and the safety of their neighbors.

A pod is NOT:

- A large open group anyone can join.
- A chatroom with strangers.
- A top-down organization.
- A replacement for legal, medical, or community aid (it *coordinates* those, it doesn't replace them).

Instead, a pod is a **hyper-local, trust-based response team**. It allows neighbors and allies to:

- **Monitor and report ICE or police activity** in real time.
- **Coordinate legal, medical, and safety support** without relying on the state.
- **Build trust and resilience** in their community.
- **Connect to the wider ICE Tea Tools network** for regional coordination when needed.

Pods are **autonomous** but connected. They decide their own processes and boundaries while benefiting from shared tools like:

- **ICE Tea Watch** (public reporting + heatmaps)
- **ICE Tea Dispatch** (coordinated volunteer and pod response)
- **ICE Tea Academy** (training and certification)

Why Pods Matter:

- They **bridge the gap** between individual neighbors and large activist organizations.
- They provide **rapid, flexible responses** without the delays and bureaucracy that slow down big groups.
- They **build trust locally**. Members know each other, rather than relying on strangers.
- They **make communities harder to target** by showing ICE and other state actors that **people are organized, trained, and watching**.

Core Principles of Pod Organizing

No cops. No compromise.

We protect each other, not by outsourcing to the state, but by organizing ourselves. Law enforcement cannot be relied on to protect our communities. They are often the threat.

Trust first, numbers second.

Pods are about **quality, not quantity**. A pod of **3 people who fully trust each other** is stronger than a pod of 20 with loose ties. New members must be vetted before being trusted with sensitive roles or information.

Mutual aid, not charity.

A pod isn't a service provider. Every member brings something. Time, skills, food, space, money, or connections. Support flows **both ways**, even if contributions look different.

Decentralized but connected.

Pods make their own decisions but connect through ICE Tea Tools for:

- Verified alerts (via Watch)
- Coordinated response (via Dispatch)
- Training and shared standards (via Academy)
- This keeps pods **independent but aligned**.

Prepared, not paranoid.

Pods plan ahead for likely scenarios (ICE raids, harassment, emergencies) without burning out. Focus on **realistic risks** and **clear action steps**, not abstract fear.

Security is everyone's job.

- Protect sensitive information.
- Be cautious with social media.
- Assume communications may be monitored and act accordingly.
- Regularly review **security practices as a group**.

Pod Roles at a Glance

Every pod, no matter how small, benefits from **clear roles**, even if some people double up. Roles can rotate, but someone should always be responsible for each:

- **Point Person (Pod Lead):**
 - Acts as the main contact with ICE Tea Dispatch.
 - Ensures everyone completes necessary Academy training.
 - Handles pod registration and coordination.
- **Outreach Lead:**
 - Uses the Starter Kit to table, hand out flyers, and recruit.
 - Ensures the pod is visible enough to grow but not overexposed.
- **Logistics/Legal Contact:**
 - Maintains up-to-date hotline numbers, legal aid contacts, and resource lists.
 - Prepares “grab-and-go” kits for emergencies (documents, first aid, radios).
- **Responders (Flexible):**
 - Legal observers, medics, de-escalators, or drivers as needed.
 - Should complete **Field Responder Training** via the Academy.
- **Backup/Admin Support:**
 - Helps with scheduling, tracking who’s trained, and maintaining contact lists.

Even if a pod is just **two people**, you can still assign these roles so there’s no confusion during emergencies.

Core Principles

- **No cops. No compromise.** We protect our own without relying on the state.
- **Trust first.** Only work with people you know or can vouch for.
- **Move fast, stay secure.** Pods are built to act when others can’t.
- **Mutual aid, not charity.** Everyone contributes what they can: time, skills, or resources.

Step 1: Starting Your Pod

A pod starts small. **2 to 5 trusted people** can build the foundation for a functional, responsive group. The focus at the beginning isn't scale; it's **trust, communication, and clarity**.

1. Find Your Core Members

- **Start with people you already know and trust:** friends, neighbors, coworkers, or family members.
- Aim for **diverse skills and availability** (someone with free time during the day, someone with a car, someone connected to local groups).
- **Do not post open recruitment ads** at this stage.
 - Large, unvetted groups can lead to infiltration or unreliability.
 - Growth comes later, after your pod is secure and stable.

Questions to ask before inviting someone:

- Are they dependable when plans change quickly?
- Are they willing to learn (even if they're not experienced)?
- Do they share the values of **mutual aid, security, and no collaboration with law enforcement?**
- Are they ready to commit at least a little time each month (or be honest about their limits)?

2. Set Up a Secure Communication Channel

- Use **Signal** for group chats.
- Disable message history for extra safety ("Disappearing Messages" set to 1 week or less).
- Avoid adding people to the group unless the **whole pod agrees**.
- Back up critical info like hotline numbers somewhere **offline** (a paper card or encrypted note).

If you need to use email for coordination:

- Create a **shared, anonymous account** (no real names).
- Use ProtonMail or Tutanota instead of Gmail.

Never use:

- SMS texts
- Open Discord/Telegram servers
- Facebook Messenger or Instagram DMs

3. Choose Initial Roles

Even in a pod of 2 or 3 people, assign **specific roles** so there's no confusion during emergencies. Roles can rotate, but someone needs to be responsible for each.

- **Point Person (Pod Lead)**
 - Acts as the **main contact with ICE Tea Dispatch and Academy**.
 - Make sure the pod is **registered** and has access to Watch and Dispatch alerts.
 - Tracks pod progress (who's trained, what gear you have).
- **Outreach Lead**
 - Manages flyers, tabling, and recruitment events using the Starter Kit.
 - Ensures outreach is **targeted and safe** (no revealing sensitive details).
- **Logistics/Legal Contact**
 - Keeps emergency contacts (legal aid, mutual aid, translators).
 - Maintains **grab-and-go kits** (first aid, radios, printed maps, contact lists).
 - Coordinates with Dispatch if the pod gets activated.
- **Responders (Optional)**
 - Members who train as **legal observers, medics, de-escalators, or drivers**.
 - Should complete **Field Responder Training** through the Academy.

It's okay if one person handles multiple roles at first: the key is that **every task is covered**.

4. Register Your Pod

Once your pod has its core members:

- **Register with ICE Tea Tools** so you're included in the regional directory.
- Gain access to:
 - Verified **alerts through Watch and Dispatch**
 - **Starter Kit** (physical materials + digital resources)
 - **Academy Pod Creator Track** (training for leads)

Registration also helps other pods and Dispatch know your **capabilities and coverage area** without exposing personal information.

5. Set Expectations Early

Pods work best when everyone knows **what they're signing up for**. At your first meeting (or first Signal chat):

- Discuss **availability** (how often can each person be on call or attend events?).
- Agree on **security practices** (e.g., “no names in texts,” “no sharing locations publicly”).
- Clarify **your pod's focus**. Some pods mainly monitor and report, while others train for field work.
- Decide how often you'll **check in or meet** (weekly, biweekly, or monthly).

Quick-Start Checklist for Step 1

- Found 2–5 trusted people
- Created a Signal group (with disappearing messages)
- Assigned at least **Point Person, Outreach Lead, and Logistics Contact**
- Registered with ICE Tea Tools (directory + alerts)
- Ordered or received a Starter Kit
- Scheduled your first **check-in meeting**
- Discussed security practices and availability

Pro Tips for New Pods

- **Start small and grow carefully.**
Trust takes time; avoid adding strangers too quickly.
- **Don't wait for perfection.**
A pod of 2 people ready to act is better than a group of 10 still planning.
- **Document everything that matters: Securely.**
Keep copies of your pod contacts, regional hotlines, and key resources **offline** (laminated cards, notebooks).
- **Train as you grow.**
Encourage every new member to complete the **General Member Training** in the Academy as soon as they join.

Step 2: Secure Communications

Communication is the **most common vulnerability** for pods. If you're sloppy about how you talk and share information, your pod can be compromised before it ever hits the streets. This section explains how to **set up safe channels, avoid leaks, and keep your team operational even under pressure.**

Why Communication Security Matters

- State agencies (ICE, police, fusion centers) actively **monitor social media, open group chats, and phone metadata.**
- Infiltration often starts with **info leaks**: meeting times, names, roles, or tactics shared too freely.
- Even if you aren't doing anything illegal, **sensitive data can be used to harass, intimidate, or target members.**

The Pod Comms Standard

1. **Use encrypted apps only.**
 - **Signal** is the default for chat.
 - For voice/video, use **Signal calls or Jitsi (self-hosted).**
 - Avoid Telegram, Discord, or Slack for anything sensitive, they **aren't truly secure.**
2. **Lock down group chats.**
 - Use **disappearing messages** (1 week or less).
 - Disable link previews in Signal (prevents accidental leaks).
 - Don't name your group anything obvious like "ICE Watchers", keep it neutral.
3. **Keep sensitive data off phones.**
 - Store **hotline numbers, roles, and key contacts offline** (laminated cards or notebooks).
 - Don't text people's full names or addresses, use roles ("Medic-1," "Observer-2") if needed.
4. **Use separate devices if possible.**
 - Have a **pod phone** or a **cheap secondary phone** for outreach and pod work.
 - Keep your personal phone off or away during sensitive operations (phones constantly track location, even when idle).

Threat Scenarios to Watch For

- **Scenario 1: Social Media Overshare**

Someone posts about pod activity or meetings on Facebook/Instagram.

- **Response:**

- Take the post down immediately.
- Remind the pod that **no public social posts** should reveal operations or member details.

- **Scenario 2: Unknown Contact Joins Chat**

A “friend of a friend” is added to the Signal group without the pod’s approval.

- **Response:**

- Remove them until the pod can **vet and agree**.
- Review who has admin rights to the chat.

- **Scenario 3: Phone Confiscation or Loss**

A pod member loses a phone or it’s seized by police.

- **Response:**

- Treat all stored info as **potentially compromised**.
- Lock down the group (change settings, rotate chat links, use new codes for meetups).

Best Practices for Everyday Use

- **Rotate meeting times and locations** to avoid predictable patterns.
- Avoid putting **locations or times in chat**: use voice calls or encrypted notes for details.
- Agree on **cover stories** if someone asks what your group does (e.g., “community outreach group,” “neighborhood volunteers”).
- Use **burner emails** (ProtonMail or Tutanota) for any sign-ups or event coordination.

Backup Plans if Tech Fails

Your pod should have at least one **non-digital backup method** for critical communication.

Options include:

- **Pre-arranged meeting points** (“If phones go down, meet at X within 1 hour”).
- **Physical message drops** (sealed notes left at a neutral location).
- **Walkie-talkies or radio kits** (included in some Starter Kits).

Every pod should know:

- Where to meet if Signal or the internet is cut off.
- How to signal “all clear” or “abort” during operations without phones (hand signs, color codes, or pre-arranged signals).

Quick Checklist for Step 2

- Signal group set up with disappearing messages and neutral name
- At least one **pod phone or secondary device** (if possible)
- All members briefed on **no social posts, no public leaks**
- Critical info stored **offline** (cards or notebooks)
- Pre-arranged **meeting points and backup plan** set
- Radio kit or drop-point system (optional but recommended)

Pro Tips for Pod Comms

- **Train new members immediately** on these standards. Don't assume they know.
- **Review comms protocols monthly** as a pod.
- Use **code words for emergencies** ("Standby," "Abort," "All Clear") so everyone knows what to do with minimal chatter.
- If a member leaves the pod, **reset all codes and Signal groups immediately**.

Step 3: Growing Your Pod

Once your pod is stable (you've got **2–5 trusted members, secure comms, and clear roles**), it's time to **carefully grow**. Growth allows your pod to:

- Cover more shifts and alerts
- Support more people in the community
- Add specialized skills (medics, legal observers, translators)
- Strengthen its ability to **respond to threats quickly and effectively**

But growth has to be **intentional**. Adding the wrong people or expanding too fast can compromise your pod's security and reliability.

1. When (and Why) to Grow

Only start recruiting when:

- Your **core team feels confident and organized**
- You have a **secure Signal group and roles clearly assigned**
- At least one member has **completed General Member Training** in the Academy
- You've agreed as a group on **how new members will be vetted and onboarded**

Growing for the sake of size can backfire. Every new person adds potential risk if they aren't trained, vetted, and committed.

2. Where to Recruit

The safest way to find new members is through **in-person, community-based connections**, not online blasts.

Best sources:

- **Tabling at events** (community centers, farmers markets, local festivals)
- **Flyer distribution** (QR codes for interest forms that don't reveal pod details)
- **Trusted referrals** (friends, neighbors, allies already vouched for)
- **Community groups and spaces** (mutual aid networks, food banks, cultural centers)

Avoid:

- Random social media ads
- Open invites to big public meetings
- Taking in people you can't verify at all

3. How to Recruit Safely

Use your Pod Starter Kit materials:

- Flyers and posters with **QR codes** linking to a neutral interest form (hosted by ICE Tea Tools, not personal emails).
- A **tabling banner and laminated handouts** for visibility without exposing personal info.
- Stickers or buttons with **Watch and Academy links** (not private pod details).

At events:

- Keep your **pod name and members anonymous**: you're there to promote **ICE Tea Tools**, not your specific pod.
- Direct interested people to **fill out the form or attend a general info session** instead of handing out your phone number.
- If possible, **have 2 people at every tabling event** for safety and to help field questions.

4. Vetting New Members

Before anyone joins your Signal group:

- Review their **form submission or info session participation**.
- At least one pod member should **vouch for them** or verify their connection to the community.
- Ask **basic screening questions** (informal, but clear):
 - Why are you interested in joining?
 - Are you comfortable with **no collaboration with law enforcement**?
 - Are you willing to complete **General Member Training**?
 - Do you have any **special skills or limitations** we should know (first aid, translation, mobility needs)?

If there's any doubt, **offer training access and Watch participation first** but don't bring them fully into the pod yet.

5. Onboarding Process

New members should:

1. **Complete General Member Training** in the Academy within 2 weeks.
2. Attend a **pod orientation meeting** (review security, roles, expectations).
3. Be added to the **Signal group only after orientation**.
4. Start with **low-risk roles** (outreach, note-taking) until they're proven reliable.

6. Keeping Your Pod Organized as It Grows

- **Track who's trained and what roles they can fill** (use the template in Handbook).
- Hold **monthly check-ins** (30–60 minutes) to review:
 - Pod size and roles
 - Any new member concerns
 - Readiness for upcoming events or alerts
- Keep your pod **lean**. If you hit more than 10 people, consider **splitting into two pods** so decision-making stays fast.

Quick Checklist for Step 3

- Pod core team is trained, roles set, and registered
- Recruitment materials ready (flyers, tabling gear, QR codes)
- Clear vetting and onboarding process agreed on
- New members complete **General Member Training** before taking on key roles
- Monthly check-ins scheduled to maintain trust and readiness

Pro Tips for Growth

- **Quality > quantity.**
A pod of 5 trained, reliable people will outwork a pod of 20 loosely connected ones.
- **Use the Academy as your gatekeeper.**
People who can't finish a 30-minute training probably won't stick around.
- **Document everything carefully.**
Use the **pod roster template** to track roles and training, don't just trust memory.
- **Split before you get too big.**
Two pods of 8 are safer, faster, and more effective than one pod of 16.

Step 4: Staying Safe & Secure

A pod's strength doesn't just come from numbers or tools. It comes from **how well it protects its members and operations**. Security isn't about paranoia; it's about **building habits** that keep your pod functional even when things get tense. This section covers **personal safety, operational security (OpSec), and group practices** to make sure your pod can act without unnecessary risks.

1. Why Security Matters

- ICE, police, and private security regularly **monitor community networks** and will exploit sloppy practices.
- Even without direct state interference, **doxxing, harassment, and infiltration** can shut down pods if they aren't careful.
- Good security **prevents crises** before they happen and **keeps pods calm and reliable** when things heat up.

2. Core Security Practices

Every pod member should follow these **baseline rules**:

1. **Keep your personal life separate from pod work.**
 - Don't mix personal social media with pod communications.
 - Avoid posting about operations or pod members publicly.
2. **Never use real names unnecessarily.**
 - Use roles ("Observer 1," "Medic 2") or initials in notes and chats.
 - Protect each other's identities when possible.
3. **Limit who knows what.**
 - Only share **need-to-know information** (locations, plans) with those directly involved.
 - Avoid discussing sensitive plans in group settings where not everyone is active.
4. **Regularly rotate codes and check security.**
 - Change Signal group links or codes every few months.
 - Review OpSec practices at least once per quarter as a pod.

3. Meeting Safely

Pods work best when members meet in person at least occasionally. But those meetings need to be **planned with care**:

- **Rotate meeting locations** (cafes, libraries, parks, community spaces).
- Avoid using **personal homes** for sensitive discussions unless everyone agrees.
- Keep **meeting sizes small** (5–7 max): large gatherings draw attention.
- Agree on **cover stories** ("community outreach group," "volunteer planning") in case someone asks.

Never:

- Announce meeting times or locations publicly.
- Share addresses over insecure channels (always send via Signal or voice).
- Store meeting notes in the cloud without encryption.

4. Handling Sensitive Information

Pods often handle **legal contacts, translator lists, incident notes, and maps** that can't fall into the wrong hands. Best practices:

- Store documents **encrypted** (ProtonDrive, Tresorit, or a password-protected local folder).
- Keep **printed copies of key info** (hotlines, checklists) in a safe, secure place.
- Shred or burn outdated paper notes (don't toss them in the trash).

For incident notes (like legal observations):

- **Keep them factual and neutral** (avoid personal opinions).
- **Hand them to trusted legal aid** as soon as possible, then delete securely.

5. Personal Safety for Pod Members

When your pod is in the field (tabling, responding, observing):

- **Go in pairs or teams:** No one should operate alone.
- **Dress neutrally** (avoid flashy or politically loud clothing unless serving as a visible legal observer).
- Carry **basic first aid and water** (especially for hot weather or long actions).
- Have an **exit plan** for every location (where to retreat, how to get a ride).
- Designate a **check-in contact** (a pod member not on site who knows where you are and can call for help).

6. What To Do If Compromised

If you suspect **infiltration, surveillance, or a leak**:

1. **Pause all sensitive operations** until the situation is assessed.
2. **Meet as a pod (in person if possible)** to discuss evidence and concerns.
3. **Reset codes and comms** (Signal groups, passwords, meeting points).
4. If needed, **contact ICE Tea Dispatch** for guidance on handling the breach.
5. **Document the situation privately** (without naming suspects) so the pod can prevent future issues.

Quick Checklist for Step 4

- All members briefed on **OpSec basics** (no names, no leaks)
- Meeting rotation and cover stories agreed on
- Sensitive info stored **securely (encrypted or offline)**
- Exit plans and check-ins in place for field actions
- Plan ready for **breaches or infiltration** (reset codes, pause ops, debrief)

Pro Tips for Staying Safe

- **Normalize check-ins.**
Quick “safe and home” messages after shifts or actions help reduce anxiety.
- **Review security after every major action.**
Small habits (like someone leaving a note unshredded) can become vulnerabilities if ignored.
- **Build trust through consistency.**
The more your pod practices secure habits, the less stress and chaos you face when something actually happens.

Step 5: Responding to Activity

A pod's ultimate purpose is to **act quickly and effectively when ICE or law enforcement threatens your community**. This doesn't always mean rushing into the field. Sometimes the best action is to verify, escalate, and support others. This section covers how your pod should **verify reports, mobilize safely, and debrief after an incident** while staying secure and effective.

1. Verify Before You Act

Not every report is real, acting on false information can waste resources and put your pod at risk.

Steps to verify:

1. **Check ICE Tea Watch** for reports and heatmaps in your area.
2. **Contact Dispatch** if you need confirmation or cross-checking.
3. Use **your pod's own eyes** (drive-by, on-foot observation) if safe and discreet.
4. Only **mobilize your pod** when:
 - You have **at least two independent confirmations**, OR
 - The situation is ongoing and confirmed by Dispatch.

Never:

- Share unverified reports publicly (social media, mass texts).
- Confront suspected agents or officers directly without trained legal observers.
- Assume the first report is accurate. Always double-check.

2. Decide Your Pod's Role

Not every pod responds the same way. Decide **before mobilizing** what role your pod will play based on skills, training, and risk tolerance.

Common pod response roles:

- **Observers** – Document activity, take photos (if safe), and collect witness info.
- **Supporters** – Provide water, food, or shelter to impacted families.
- **De-escalators** – Keep tensions down, help prevent violence.
- **Legal Connectors** – Call legal hotlines, connect families to lawyers.
- **Rapid Responders** – Work with Dispatch to move people, supplies, or other pods.

If your pod lacks the skills for certain roles (like legal observation), **coordinate with Dispatch** to bring in trained volunteers.

3. Mobilize Safely

Once verified, follow a **clear activation plan**:

1. **Notify your pod** via Signal with only essential details (time, place, role assignments).
2. **Confirm roles** (who's driving, observing, supporting).
3. **Bring essentials only**:
 - First aid kit, water, ID (if you choose), pod cards (for contacts).
 - Radios or pod phone (if available).
 - Neutral clothing and comfortable shoes.
4. **Meet at a staging point first**, not at the exact site. This lets you assess the situation as a group.

Avoid:

- Broadcasting location publicly.
- Going in alone.
- Wearing obvious “activist” or political clothing (unless serving as a **clearly marked legal observer**).

4. During the Incident

Your pod's focus is **support and documentation**, not confrontation.

- **Stay calm and visible** (unless your role is discreet observation).
- **Follow Dispatch or legal observer instructions** if on site.
- **Record video only when safe**, keep your phone locked when not in use.
- **Do not engage with ICE or police beyond your role** (unless you're trained to do so)

If someone is detained:

1. **Document everything** (time, place, vehicle numbers, officers' names if visible).
2. **Contact legal aid** using your hotline list immediately.
3. **Support the family or impacted person** by connecting them to resources.

5. After the Incident

Once the situation is resolved or cleared:

1. **Debrief as a pod within 24 hours**:
 - What went well?
 - What needs to improve?
 - Did anyone feel unsafe or need support?
2. **Report back to Dispatch**:
 - Confirm the event details for Watch (times, locations, outcomes).
 - Share any useful documentation securely.
3. **Check on your members**:
 - Look for signs of stress, burnout, or trauma.
 - Encourage breaks and peer support when needed.

4. **Reset if needed:**

- If your Signal chat or radios were exposed, reset codes.
- Update your pod roster if roles changed.

Quick Checklist for Step 5

- Report verified via Watch, Dispatch, or firsthand observation
- Pod roles assigned before mobilization
- Essentials packed (first aid, water, radios, contacts)
- Staging point and exit plan confirmed
- Debrief scheduled and report submitted to Dispatch

Pro Tips for Response

- **Document, don't escalate.**
The most effective pods are calm, clear, and professional. Escalation can put people in danger.
- **Practice "dry runs."**
Simulate a response once a month to keep your pod fast and organized.
- **Let Dispatch handle scale-ups.**
Your pod doesn't need to handle everything: coordinate for legal, media, or large-scale support.

Step 6: Templates & Tools

Every pod receives a **Starter Kit** when registered with ICE Tea Tools. This section provides **examples, checklists, and templates** so Pod Organizers can easily customize them for their region and needs.

1. Flyer Template (Recruitment & Outreach)

Purpose:

To educate the public about ICE Tea Tools and invite trusted people to connect, without revealing sensitive pod details.

Sample Text (front):



ICE Tea Tools

A community-powered network for alerts, training, and response.

No cops. No compromise. All community.

Join us to:

- Learn your rights
- Respond to ICE and police threats
- Build local defense pods

Scan to learn more or connect securely.

[QR Code Here]

Sample Text (back):

How It Works:

- Report sightings safely via ICE Tea Watch
- Get trained through ICE Tea Academy
- Join or form a trusted local pod

Together, we protect each other.

Visit: icetea.peoplesrebellion.org

Every pod can request printed flyers or download editable versions.

2. Pod Sign-Up Form Template

Purpose:

To collect potential member info without exposing the pod or existing members.

Never ask for sensitive details like home address or full legal name at the first stage.

Name (optional, encouraged to use nickname):
Preferred Contact: Signal / Email / Trusted In Person Contact / Other
Primary Skills:
Availability (Days/Hours Per Week)
Comfort level: Outreach / Field Work / Support / Logistics
Completed Academy Training? Yes / No / Needs Help

Other Notable Information:

3. Emergency Hotline Template

Each pod should maintain a **printed card** and **digital copy** with:

Example Layout (Card):

ICE Tea Emergency Card: Region X				
Legal Aid Hotline:	ICE Rapid Response:	Translator (Spanish):	Pod Contact:	Dispatch Contact:

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ICE Tea Emergency Card: Region X				
Legal Aid Hotline:	ICE Rapid Response:	Translator (Spanish):	Pod Contact:	Dispatch Contact:

4. Sample Pod Meeting Agenda

Monthly Check-In (30–45 minutes):

1. Quick personal check-in (how's everyone doing?)
2. Review pod roster (who's trained, who's new)
3. Discuss recent incidents or alerts
4. Plan next outreach or training goals
5. Review OpSec practices (are we slipping anywhere?)
6. Wrap-up and set next meeting

5. Tabling Checklist

For pods running outreach tables at events:

- Flyers and laminated info sheets
- Sign-up form (paper or tablet)
- Stickers or buttons
- Banner or sign (neutral branding, no sensitive info)
- Clipboards, pens, and tape
- Pod Quick Start handouts (optional, 1-page version)
- Water, snacks, and basic first aid
- Two people minimum for safety
- Cash box or donation QR (if approved by pod)

6. Debrief Template

After incidents, pods should document key info (without sensitive names) for reporting back to Dispatch.

Fields:

- Date & Time of Incident
- Location (cross streets, city)
- Type of Activity (ICE raid, checkpoint, harassment)
- Pod Members Present (roles only, no names)
- Actions Taken (observed, supported, connected to legal, etc.)
- Outcome (detentions, dispersal, legal escalation)
- Any Follow-Up Needed

This form can be stored securely (encrypted digital or paper) and shared with Dispatch through secure channels.

Quick Checklist for Step 6

- Flyers customized with local QR code and contact info
- Sign-up form ready for tabling events
- Emergency hotline card printed and distributed to pod members
- Monthly meeting agenda prepared
- Tabling kit packed and inventoried
- Debrief form set up and tested

Pro Tips for Using Templates

- **Keep everything flexible.**
Your pod can adapt templates to fit local needs but keep core security standards (no unnecessary personal data, no public meeting info).
 - **Laminate key items.**
Flyers and cards last longer, and lamination protects against weather and wear.
 - **Train everyone to use the forms.**
Even if someone is new, they should know how to collect sign-ups or fill out a debrief form correctly.
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Quick Checklist for New Pods

- 2–5 core trusted members
- Secure Signal group created
- Roles assigned (Point, Outreach, Logistics)
- Registered with ICE Tea Tools
- Received Starter Kit
- Completed General Member training
- Ready to table and recruit
- Agreed on security and debrief practices

Step 7: Quick Checklist & Next Steps

This section gives Pod Organizers a **single-page reference (front & back)** for building, maintaining, and activating a pod and clear next actions to keep the group ready.

Pod Organizer Quick Checklist

Core Setup

- 2–5 trusted members (vouched for and trained)
- Signal group created (disappearing messages enabled)
- Roles assigned (Point Person, Outreach Lead, Logistics/Legal)
- Registered with ICE Tea Tools (access to Watch, Dispatch, Academy)
- Starter Kit received (flyers, forms, laminated cards)

Security Practices

- All members briefed on **OpSec basics** (no public leaks, no names)
- Meeting rotation and **cover stories agreed on**
- Emergency contacts stored **offline and encrypted**
- Backup communication plan in place (meeting point or radio kit)
- Codes, Signal links, and passwords rotated quarterly

Growth & Training

- Flyers and sign-up form customized for your region
- Monthly tabling or outreach plan active
- Vetting and onboarding process written and followed
- All members have completed **General Member Training**
- Field Responders and Dispatchers certified through Academy (if needed)

Response Readiness

- Verified incident response process drilled at least once a month
- Staging point and exit plans updated for current coverage area
- Pod roster up to date (who's trained and available)
- Debrief process tested (forms and reporting to Dispatch).

Preventing Burnout

- **Rotate roles every 1–2 months** so no one carries the same responsibility too long.
- Schedule **downtime and off-call periods** for every member.
- Celebrate small wins (successful tabling, new member trained, incident debrief completed) to keep morale up.

Funding Your Pod

- Beyond Ko-fi and centralized fundraising, pods can raise money locally:
 - **Community dinners or potlucks** (donations support flyers or radios).
 - **Skillshares and workshops** (first aid, secure comms) with sliding-scale entry.
 - **Partnerships with local mutual aid funds** to cover costs.

Stipends for Pod Leads

For pods where the **Point Person's role is near full-time**:

- Consider a **monthly stipend** funded through donations or pooled pod funds.
- Keep records transparent so trust stays high.

Next Steps for Pod Organizers

1. **Complete the Pod Creator Track** in the ICE Tea Academy.
 - Covers organizing, vetting, security, and Dispatch coordination.
 - Certifies you as a Pod Creator, giving your pod priority for verified dispatch alerts.
2. **Schedule Your First Outreach Event.**
 - Use your tabling checklist and Starter Kit to recruit 1–3 new vetted members.
 - Focus on community spaces not social media blasts.
3. **Run a Dry-Run Drill.**
 - Simulate an incident report: verify, assign roles, stage, and debrief.
 - Make sure every pod member knows their role and can act quickly.
4. **Connect Regionally.**
 - Coordinate with other pods via Dispatch for shared coverage.
 - Identify **regional roles** (translator lists, extra medics, supply runners).
5. **Keep Your Pod Sustainable.**
 - Apply for extra Starter Kits as your pod grows.
 - Use <https://ko-fi.com/techwitch> to fund new flyers, radios, and stipends for Pod Leads.
 - Hold **monthly check-ins** to maintain morale and readiness.

Why It Matters

ICE Tea Tools isn't just about responding to raids. It's about **building a culture of readiness, care, and collective power**. Pods make communities harder to target and harder to break. Every well-trained pod brings us closer to a future where **no one faces state violence alone**.

Pod Creator Certification & Support:

Once your pod is active, you can:

- Get **priority for verified Dispatch alerts**
- Receive **discounted or free additional Starter Kits**
- Connect with **regional training and supply networks**

**Complete your Pod Creator certification today:
Start the Track in the Academy**

Appendix A: Know Your Rights & Legal Prep

Why This Matters:

Pods often face law enforcement interactions, either directly or while supporting others. Knowing rights reduces panic and mistakes.

1. Your Basic Rights

- **Right to remain silent.**
 - You do **not** need to answer questions about immigration status, citizenship, or where you were born.
 - State clearly: *"I am exercising my right to remain silent. I want to speak to a lawyer."*
- **Right to refuse searches.**
 - If ICE or police ask to enter your home or vehicle, say: *"I do not consent to a search."*
 - Only a **judge-signed warrant** (not an ICE admin warrant) allows forced entry.
- **Right to an attorney.**
 - If detained, keep saying: *"I am requesting a lawyer and will not answer questions."*

2. Pod Protocols During Interactions

- Always have **legal hotlines on your pod's emergency card**.
- Designate one member as **Legal Liaison** during responses:
 - Calls hotlines, records agent badge numbers, coordinates with lawyers.
- Do not engage in arguments or physical confrontation. Your role is to observe, **document, and connect to legal support**.

3. If a Pod Member is Detained

1. **Notify your pod immediately.**
2. **Contact legal aid and Dispatch.**
3. Document time, place, agency, and any vehicles or officers involved.
4. Support their family or dependents through mutual aid connections.

Resource:

Contact the **National Lawyers Guild** for local chapters: <https://www.nlg.org/chapters/>

Appendix B: Crisis Drills & Tabletop Scenarios

Pods should **practice regularly** so real-world incidents aren't their first time coordinating.

How to Use These Cards

- Print each as a **double-sided card (4x6 or 5x7)**.
- **Front:** Scene and Goal (for facilitator to read aloud).
- **Back:** Roles, Actions, and **Suggested Lines** (for easy roleplay).
- Run during **training nights, monthly meetings, or pop-up drills**.
- Encourage pods to **rotate facilitators** so everyone practices leading.

Card 1 – Infiltration Response Drill

Scene (Read Aloud):

"You're in a pod meeting when a new person shows up. They keep asking, 'Who runs this pod? Where's the money kept? Shouldn't we be doing something more direct to stop ICE?' They mention knowing details about another pod's plans even though they just joined. The energy feels off. People are uncomfortable. What do you do?"

Goal:

Practice spotting red flags, pausing operations, and debriefing without panic.

Roles & Lines:

- **Facilitator (Narrator):**
 - "Pause. Let's stop for a moment and check in. Does anyone else feel uneasy about what's being asked here?"
 - "Remember, no naming names, just focus on behaviors."
- **OpSec Lead:**
 - "We're going to reset our codes and Signal groups after this. No action is being planned tonight."
 - "Let's revisit our security guidelines before we move on."
- **Recorder:**
 - "Let's make a quick note of the behaviors we flagged so we can review as a pod later."
 - "What changes can we make to avoid this in the future?"

Card 2 – Mass Detention Scenario

Scene (Read Aloud):

"You're monitoring a march when ICE and police swarm the area. Five people, including two pod members, are detained. Family members are calling in panic. Dispatch needs details, and your pod has to coordinate legal aid, support for families, and documentation immediately."

Goal:

Coordinate legal and family support under pressure while managing information flow.

Roles & Lines:

- **Observers (Document):**

- "I'm getting footage now. No faces unless consent is given. I'll send time-stamped updates to the Communications Lead."
- "Marking the exact location and number of officers present."

- **Legal Liaison:**

- "Calling the NLG hotline now. I'll pass them detainee info as soon as we confirm it."
- "Can someone verify the names and contacts so I can relay to the lawyer?"

- **Family Support:**

- "We're setting up food and childcare for affected families. If anyone needs a translator, I'll coordinate one."
- "Stay calm, we're working with legal to get updates."

- **Field Team Lead:**

- "Observers, keep feeding info to Dispatch. Legal Liaison, keep the hotline open. Family Support, coordinate translators. Let's keep this organized."

Card 3 – Tabletop Exercise: Full Response Simulation

Scene (Read Aloud):

"Dispatch flags a report: multiple unmarked vans near a known staging point. Could be ICE, could be routine. Your pod has 15 minutes to decide whether to verify, mobilize, or stand down. Assign roles, coordinate through Signal, and prepare a full debrief after."

Goal:

Run through the full cycle: verify, mobilize, coordinate, debrief.

Roles & Lines:

- **Point Person (Pod Lead):**

- "Everyone, we need quick clarity. Scouts, can you confirm what's happening on-site?"
- "Communications, get in touch with Dispatch and let them know we're verifying."

- **Communications Lead:**

- "I'm opening a secure Signal channel now. Scouts, send updates there only. I'll relay to Dispatch."
- "Do we have a fallback plan if this is confirmed as a raid?"

- **Logistics Lead:**

- "If we mobilize, we'll meet at Staging Point Alpha in 20 minutes. Everyone confirm transport options."
- "If it's a false alarm, we regroup and note what worked and didn't."

- **Scouts:**

- "Moving to the staging area now. Will confirm vehicle plates and behavior."
- "If I see ICE IDs or detentions, I'll signal immediately."

Appendix C: Low-Tech Ops & Accessibility Tools

1. Communication Without Internet or Signal

- **Radios:**
 - Each Starter Kit can include 2 handheld radios for pods that request them.
 - Use pre-set channels, rotate frequencies for privacy.
- **Ham Radio Operators:**
 - Consider recruiting a licensed operator for long-range coverage.
 - Useful during widespread outages or surveillance shutdowns.

2. Dead Drops & Physical Signals

- Use **neutral drop points** (community bulletin boards, safe mail slots) for leaving written notes.
- Agree on **color-coded flags or chalk marks** for discreet alerts (e.g., a colored ribbon on a lamppost = “meet at point B”).

3. Accessibility for All Members

- Translate key materials into **Spanish and other local languages**.
- Use **visual signals and written notes** for members who are deaf or hard of hearing.
- Provide **alternative text formats** for members with visual impairments (large print or digital screen-reader files).

Support the Network

Every pod gets materials and Academy access through **community donations**.

If you want to help more pods form, or keep your own sustainable. Please contribute.

Donate at: <https://ko-fi.com/techwitch>